Energy flows in a small estuary

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Abstract

We measure the energy flows of a small estuary over one year and compare them with a simple model. The model reproduces the seasonal pattern.

Keywords: emergy, estuary, systems ecology

1. Introduction

Estuaries collect energy from the tide, the river and the sun. This paper follows the method of Odum [1].

1.1. Study site

The estuary is small enough to be sampled in a day, which lets every flow be measured on the same day of each month of the year.

2. Results

The model reproduces the seasonal pattern of the measured flows.

References

[1] H. T. Odum, Systems Ecology: An Introduction, Wiley, New York, 1983.

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